

Young Trilateral Leaders

Regional Cooperation Roundtable

Busan Final Report

December 19-20, 2025

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Jinwan Park | SeungHwan Kim | JoongEon An | Ji-Yun Park | Daehan Lee | Joseph Sejin Kim

Ⅰ. Executive Summary

This workshop brought together next-generation leaders, policy experts, and local university students to explore the future of the U.S.–ROK–Japan trilateral cooperation from a subnational, youth-driven perspective. As Busan continues to solidify its position as a global maritime hub, participants examined how maritime security, emerging technologies, and value-based alliances can be strengthened through localized collaboration. The two-day program combined expert lectures, interactive roundtables, and a policy proposal session, producing insights that will directly inform future YTL programming and Embassy-led youth diplomacy efforts.

Ⅱ. Young Trilateral Leaders Regional Cooperation Roundtable in Busan

A. Speakers' Presentations

Why the Sea Matters: Trilateral Maritime Security Cooperation - Jinwan-Park ｜ Co-Founder, US-ROK-Japan Trilateral Next-Gen Study Group

The key takeaway is that maritime security is an existential necessity for U.S.-ROK-Japan cooperation, as economic prosperity, military reinforcement, digital connectivity, and supply chains all depend on secure seas. Global order is fundamentally maritime, with disruptions at sea quickly translating into inflation, supply-chain shocks, and strategic instability, making open and rules-based oceans a shared material interest rather than an ideological choice. Trilateral cooperation is most effective at sea, where combined naval operations, coast guard coordination, and maritime domain awareness can deter aggression, manage gray-zone coercion, and enforce sanctions against actors such as North Korea, while responding to regional challenges. While not a panacea, sustained trilateral maritime cooperation raises the costs of coercion, preserves rules, and buys time and space for diplomacy.

Korea's SSN Debate and the East Asian AUKUS - SeungHwan Kim | Nonresident Fellow, Indo-Pacific Studies Center

The presentation argues that South Korea's pursuit of nuclear-powered submarines (SSNs) reflects a strategic response to intensifying Chinese grey-zone maritime activities and North Korea's provocations. It situates this debate within a deteriorating regional maritime environment marked by frequent Chinese incursions in the Yellow Sea/West Sea, expanded Chinese PMZ infrastructure, and potential Russia–DPRK technology cooperation. Building on this context, the presentation introduces an "East Asian AUKUS" framework that adapts the original AUKUS model to Northeast Asia through a dual-track structure. Pillar I focuses on US–ROK bilateral SSN cooperation, including nuclear fuel transfer arrangements, safeguards, and the parallel SSN shipbuilding leveraging Korea's industrial base. Pillar II emphasizes US–ROK–Japan trilateral interoperability, undersea domain awareness, and joint ASW operations to create an integrated deterrence architecture rather than fragmented bilateral efforts.

Understanding consensus of democratic value for advanced trilateral relations - JoongEon An ｜Research Assistant, Institute for Interdisciplinary Unification Studies, Korea University

The key takeaways of the presentation is to introduce the necessity of understanding democratic values as a method for strengthening trilateral relations between US-ROK-Japan. There are questions to be asked to enhance the understanding of this presentation. First, what is democracy? Second, do we all agree upon the value democracy has? Third, what are the values that we all agree on? Trilateral relationships are based on the ideology of democracy. The U.S saved Korea during the Korean War, under the flag of democratic value: freedom. Japan and Korea, even with their historical disputes, are quasi-aligned because both share the same ideological foundation. But in this turbulent global order, where the US refused to act upon their traditional role, where authoritarian regimes are threatening liberal order, what we need is not more regulations or political pacts. More participation of citizens, more research are not the prerequisite for trilateral relations. What we need is more understanding in democracy, and rallying up under the same, agreed value of democarcy.

B. Panelist

- **Ji-Yun Park**

  The roundtable conversations were extremely helpful in hearing how students in Busan feel about the disparity of opportunities between Seoul and the rest of Korea. It was putting them at a significant disadvantage as many internship opportunities or any extracurricular activities were centered around Seoul. However, they were hopeful in seeing that more discourse is allowing the region to strategically place opportunities and were glad to learn from the guest speakers about how geographically important Busan is for trilateral cooperation. Yet again, it was evident that the youth, especially in regional areas like Busan, are eager for their own space to step into and take initiative.

- **Seoyeong Lee**

  During the roundtable, I had the opportunity to engage with international students currently studying in Busan, whose comparative perspectives added meaningful depth to the discussion. Many participants reflected on how their prior experiences in their home countries shaped their understanding of Busan and informed their views on trilateral cooperation. In particular, a student from Bangladesh shared insights on how historical legacies and regional proximity can contribute to persistent tensions between neighboring countries, an experience that resonated across multiple national contexts. These conversations highlighted that conflict and misunderstanding are not unique to any one region, but are often shared challenges among countries with intertwined histories. From a trilateral cooperation perspective, this underscored the importance of fostering mutual understanding and sustained dialogue, especially among youth. Creating spaces for open exchange allows young people to transform personal experiences into constructive engagement and build a foundation for long-term cooperation grounded in empathy and shared values.

- **Seungbeom Ryan Som**

  The Busan roundtable featured a broader and more diverse participant group than previous sessions, including local Busan students, international students, and participants with varying levels of prior exposure to U.S.–ROK–Japan cooperation. Discussions therefore focused on establishing a shared baseline understanding of trilateral cooperation, particularly for participants encountering the concept for the first time. For

example, several international students from Europe initially associated "trilateral cooperation" with Northeast Asia more broadly and were unfamiliar with the U.S.–ROK–Japan framework, highlighting the need for clearer articulation of its scope and purpose. In response, practical explanations grounded in real programmatic and career experiences were shared. The discussion also included repeated questions regarding career pathways, with participants seeking concrete examples of how engagement in exchange programs and youth-led international initiatives can connect to professional development. These exchanges reflected both uneven levels of prior knowledge and strong interest in practical, experience-based entry points into trilateral cooperation.

- **Daehan Lee**

  China has adopted the gray-zone tactics to effectively transform the Yellow Sea into an "internal sea" under the PLA Navy's influence. For this, Beijing is replicating the same pattern shown in the South China Sea: construction of artificial structures, the militarization of maritime surveys and coast guard activities, and the deployment of maritime militia vessels. These actions complicate the diplomatic and military responses of the South Korean government and armed forces, while China's encroachments into territorial and jurisdictional waters are likely to expand gradually toward Japanese and the U.S. naval operational spaces in the Western Pacific and near Senkaku Island. Addressing these challenges requires key U.S. allies to move beyond their possessing conventional capabilities, and to acquire long-term and persistent deterrence through nuclear-powered attack submarines (SSNs). To achieve this, the Republic of Korea, the United States, and Japan should establish a special shipbuilding cooperation framework that integrates each country's respective shipbuilding, manufacturing, nuclear expertise, and supply chain. Such an arrangement fits well with the lattice-like alliance structure favored by the United States, and would help align trilateral threat awareness regarding China's maritime activities, and enables fairer burden sharing among key allies.

- **Joseph Sejin Kim**

The Busan YTL Roundtable was personally a great opportunity to learn a piece of what it takes to bring the US-ROK-Japan Trilateral Cooperation together. As a panelist who has no background in politics or economy, I was a bit anxious and wondered if I could contribute meaningfully to the discussions. That anxiousness disappeared the moment the speakers and panelists started to present their slides and views regarding their points of concern, which to my surprise consisted of much of what I did as a US Naval Officer. The focus of discussion was centered around Maritime Security and Regional Stability of Korea. One of the U.S. Navy's main mission has always been about free and open seas and it definitely requires the assistance of our major allies in East Asia, Korea and Japan. As allies who have built a strong naval force in the region with close proximity to China, their assistance in securing the Sea Lines of Communications for open and secure global maritime commerce is crucial in building Regional Security not just around East Asia, but also in South East Asia. The engagement with various students and journalists from the area proved the topic a bit difficult to absorb with the initial interaction and led to more of explaining the previous presentations in detail. I propose for future interactions/presentations to include a discussion that allows for an in-detail explanation of the general concepts of maritime security so that the audience is more perceptible of the topic at hand.

Ⅲ. Proposed Areas of Cooperation

Reflecting Busan's Leadership Role in Trilateral Cooperation

From a subnational diplomacy perspective, how can Busan contribute to future trilateral cooperation in areas such as maritime security, emerging technologies, culture, or youth engagement?

Cluster A: Maritime Security & Regional Stability

Establish a Trilateral Maritime Security City Network

A standing network of port cities across three countries with direct stakes in maritime security and naval readiness. Participating cities could include, but are not limited to: Busan, Pohang, and Jinhae (Changwon) in the ROK; Maizuru (Kyoto), Yokosuka (Kanagawa), and Kure (Hiroshima) in Japan; and key U.S. maritime hubs such as San Diego (California), Pearl Harbor-Honolulu (Hawaii), and Norfolk (Virginia). As frontline stakeholders in regional deterrence and crisis response, these regions have hosted critical naval facilities, logistics nodes, shipbuilding infrastructures, and sizable civilian maritime industries.

Regular city-level conferences, tabletop exercises, and working-level exchanges, in partnership with respective navies and coast guards, could complement existing trilateral joint military mechanisms by extending such cooperation to the local level. Regular dialogues and exercises can deepen shared threat perceptions, enhance coordination in contingency planning, improve civil-military relations, and increase readiness against gray-zone activities by regional adversaries. These activities, including coercive maritime patrols, threats against civilian shipping, and illegal construction and buoys, have increasingly jeopardized the maritime security of three countries. Institutionalizing city-to-city cooperation alongside mil-to-mil ties would improve both operational readiness and societal resilience across the Indo-Pacific's most strategically exposed coastal hubs.

Undersea Cooperation

Busan can be institutionalized as a functional hub for trilateral cooperation on submarines and undersea domain awareness by linking its geographic and industrial capabilities. Busan can host a standing trilateral Undersea Cooperation Forum (UCF) at the track-1.5 level, focused on submarine operations, undersea surveillance, and crisis management practices below the threshold of armed conflict or miscommunication. Leveraging Busan's proximity to naval bases and the shipbuilding infrastructure connecting the Dongnam belt, Busan can also support practical cooperation in submarine maintenance (MRO), logistics, and workforce training.

Logistical training and workforce training from these three countries can be conducted for trilateral undersea domain awareness coordination, anti-submarine operations, which is an area Japan is specialized in, sensor interoperability, and civil-military information sharing in the

waters. By anchoring these efforts at the subnational level, Busan will reduce diplomatic friction while sustaining continuity amid political changes.

Persistent Maritime Deterrence in the Indo-Pacific: Trilateral Shipbuilding Cooperation for Nuclear-Powered Submarines and Establishment of Allied Supply Chain

The Republic of Korea, the United States, and Japan need to form a trilateral shipbuilding and manufacturing cooperation framework aimed at the acquisition of nuclear-powered attack submarines and establishment of an allied supply chain. The United States would provide submarine reactor, nuclear safety standards, fuel management, and operational concepts based on naval experience, while South Korea and Japan would be primarily responsible for building SSNs and systems integration for interoperability. This cooperation should transform Korea–Japan shipbuilding and manufacturing relations from industrial competition into strategic collaboration focused on countering regional maritime threats. Cooperation around propulsion systems could be separated from nuclear weapons so that the framework can minimize conflict with the nonproliferation regime and clearly delineate the scope of SSN-based trilateral naval cooperation. In parallel with the consultation with Washington, the shipbuilding and advanced manufacturing capacities of South Korea and Japan could also contribute to Australia's timely acquisition of nuclear-powered submarines under the AUKUS framework, particularly through allied industrial participation, in order to address the concerns of shipbuilding and manufacturing capabilities of Australia and accelerate SSN delivery schedules.

Assuming that the U.S. Navy views the Indo-Pacific region as one theater, the special shipbuilding cooperation between the three states should be directly linked to the strategic objective of enhancing persistent surveillance and sea-denial capabilities in East Asia. South Korean and Japanese nuclear-powered submarines would enable extended submarine operations and highly covert missions vis-à-vis both North Korea and China. Through combined naval exercises, maritime intelligence sharing, and the development of shared operational concepts at sea, the three countries should institutionalize a trilateral maritime deterrence framework. This would strengthen the broader Indo-Pacific deterrence architecture, enhance alliance interoperability, and ensure that allied SSN capabilities keep pace with expanding maritime assertiveness of the authoritarian bloc in the region.

Cluster B: Youth Engagement, Cultural Exchange & Subnational Diplomacy

U.S.-ROK-Japan Maritime Tourism: Trilateral Port Partnership

Reflecting Busan's leadership as a global maritime hub, this proposal recommends establishing a U.S.-ROK-Japan Trilateral Port Partnership linking the Port of Busan, Port of Los Angeles, and Port of Osaka to advance maritime tourism, port coordination, and people-to-people exchange. The proposal builds on Busan's strong cruise performance in 2025, marked by a record 237 cruise calls and a passenger base in which U.S. and Japanese travelers accounted for approximately 21 percent and 19 percent, respectively. Recent volatility in regional cruise routing, driven by rising operational and port-related costs in parts of Northeast Asia, has further underscored Busan's value as a stable and competitive port of call. Given that many U.S. travelers prefer combined Japan and Republic of Korea itineraries when visiting Asia, a trilateral cruise corridor connecting Osaka, Busan, and Los Angeles would respond directly to market demand while reinforcing allied cooperation at the subnational level.

The expected impact of this partnership lies in its ability to translate increased maritime connectivity into sustained economic and human exchange. By enabling regular, multi-stop cruise travel among Osaka, Busan, and Los Angeles, the initiative would encourage repeat visitation and deeper familiarity among travelers, moving beyond one-time tourism toward long-term people-to-people ties. As cruise passengers move from ports into surrounding urban centers, the benefits extend directly to local economies, supporting small businesses, cultural venues, and service-sector employment. Over time, these repeated interactions would strengthen local tourism ecosystems while building durable networks of cultural understanding and affinity among citizens. In this way, maritime tourism serves not only as an economic driver, but also as a practical mechanism through which subnational cooperation reinforces broader U.S.-ROK-Japan relations.

Youth Postcard Exchange between sister cities of Busan, Fukuoka, and Los Angeles

Make use of Busan's sister-city ties with Fukuoka and Los Angeles. Creating a trilateral postcard exchange program among youth in three cities could be an effective way of boosting engagement and interest across regions. Once we build a network of penpals who exchange letters and postcards regularly, it has a high potential to increase the understanding of respective cultures and the bond between people living in distant places. Grouping people by their age, interests, and aspiring professions could contribute to building an international network of people who are willing to steadily engage with each other. Continued relationships could extend to students doing an exchange semester during university at their penpals' city, people hosting each other, or occasional house-swaps for vacations.

Since Fukuoka and Los Angeles are not sister cities themselves, Busan could serve as a mid-point where letters or postcards go through between a group of three people. Programs could easily be facilitated by schools or city offices who are looking to engage the young students or youth members of the community with each other.

Leveraging Sister-City Networks for Busan's MICE and Tourism Ecosystem

From a tourism perspective, a city's competitiveness lies not in the mere possession of resources, but in how effectively those resources are transformed into meaningful experiences. Tourism, as an assemblage of natural, cultural, and human resources, provides a powerful platform through which economic activity, international exchange, and people-to-people engagement converge.

Building on this understanding, Busan's sister-city partnerships with **Los Angeles**, **Chicago**, **Fukuoka**, and **Shimonoseki** offer strategic opportunities to activate tourism-led diplomacy within the MICE sector.

These partnerships enhance mutual familiarity and visibility between cities, contributing to tangible tourism flows—as seen in the distinct presence of Japanese visitors in Seomyeon and American visitors in Haeundae. Moreover, sister-city frameworks enable the co-creation of specialized tourism and exchange programs rooted in shared history and urban identity, such as maritime heritage and historical trade networks.

Cultural exchange initiatives developed through these networks not only attract international visitors but also support local cultural participation and urban regeneration, thereby strengthening the local economy. From a youth perspective, such tourism-linked MICE cooperation can move beyond symbolic exchange to provide concrete pathways for participation, professional exposure, and long-term international collaboration.

Establishing Busan as a Youth-Led Trilateral Public Diplomacy Platform

Busan is well positioned to serve as a sustainable subnational hub for youth engagement and public diplomacy within the U.S.–ROK–Japan trilateral framework through a recurring, youth-led annual program. As Korea's leading maritime city, Busan offers a practical platform for sustained cooperation due to its proximity to Japan, strong people-to-people exchanges, and established sister-city and municipal partnerships with Japanese and U.S. cities.

Among major non-capital cities in Korea, Busan represents the most feasible and scalable location for institutionalizing trilateral youth engagement. Its international infrastructure, global connectivity, and long-standing cooperation with Japanese port cities provide a ready foundation for trilateral programming without creating duplicative structures.

The initiative would convene university students, young professionals, and exchange alumni from the United States, the Republic of Korea, and Japan on an annual basis, integrating policy-focused discussions, culturally grounded exchange, and career-oriented programming. By operating at the municipal level on a recurring basis, the program embeds trilateral cooperation within Busan's existing civic and educational ecosystems and demonstrates the role of non-capital cities in advancing youth-led subnational diplomacy.

Ⅳ. Key Outcomes and Insights from the Busan AC Workshop

- **Seungbeom Ryan Son**

As the organizer of TogetherWeTri's second regional workshop and as a native of Busan, this program held particular significance. The Busan American Corner workshop demonstrated how youth engagement and subnational dialogue can make U.S.-ROK-Japan trilateral cooperation more accessible and relevant beyond capital-centered discussions. Bringing together a diverse group of local and international participants, the workshop underscored both the uneven levels of awareness surrounding trilateral cooperation and the strong interest among youth in understanding its practical implications. Busan's identity as a maritime city with close ties to Japan provided a tangible context for discussing trilateral cooperation, allowing participants to connect broader policy frameworks to real-world regional dynamics. The discussions reinforced the value of sustained, youth-led platforms rooted in local communities, highlighting how cities like Busan can play a meaningful role in advancing durable trilateral cooperation through open dialogue, cultural exchange, and people-to-people engagement.

- **Seoyeong Lee**

  The Busan AC Workshop offered a valuable opportunity to better understand the potential of Busan as a global maritime city and a platform for subnational trilateral cooperation. It was especially encouraging to see strong student participation and focused engagement throughout the roundtable, reflecting a genuine interest in international cooperation from a youth perspective. Conversations with local students revealed both concerns about Busan's employment ecosystem and thoughtful insights into the city's emerging opportunities in tourism, maritime industries, and global connectivity, underscoring the importance of grounding trilateral cooperation in local realities. Policy Proposal Discussions on the next day, further demonstrated how diverse themes, ranging from maritime security and economic security to culture and youth engagement, can be meaningfully integrated around shared values of trilateral cooperation.

- **Gabi Kim**

As the program lead, I was responsible for planning and managing the program from its inception. One of the most notable outcomes was the high level of engagement demonstrated by all participants, including speakers and local students. Participants were consistently proactive during sessions, and many expressed strong interest in follow-up opportunities to continue discussions and deepen their understanding of U.S.-ROK-Japan trilateral cooperation. Several speakers similarly requested additional opportunities and dedicated time to further develop and share their perspectives on the topic.

The roundtable discussions emerged as a particular highlight of the program, providing a platform for open, interactive exchange among participants from diverse backgrounds. This experience reinforced the value of regional, dialogue-driven workshops in normalizing U.S.-ROK-Japan cooperation at the local level. While top-down approaches remain important, the program demonstrated that bottom-up engagement, anchored in collaboration with subnational actors, can serve as a cornerstone for translating trilateral cooperation from a policy concept into a sustained and practical relationship. Building on this momentum, there is strong potential to institutionalize the workshop on a recurring basis and to further develop it into a policy-oriented collaboration with the Busan Metropolitan City.

- **Jinwan Park**

  Foreign policy is often perceived as distant from the everyday lives of citizens. That's why successive administrations have strived to persuade the idea that foreign policy and national security carry tangible stakes for ordinary people. The Busan workshop was a valuable opportunity, providing students with a concrete understanding of why cooperation among the United States, the Republic of Korea, and Japan matters. Located at the epicenter of geopolitical currents, Busan illustrates how maritime security cooperation undergirds not only regional stability but also economic prosperity. Interacting with students and hearing their perspectives on how the three countries can work more effectively highlighted the importance of open, civil discourse like this event in building more durable and sustainable trilateral cooperation.

- **SeungHwan Kim**

  I believe the Busan AC Workshop was an effective way to engage students and audiences unfamiliar with maritime security and strategy terminology. Since maritime security or strategy is not a common issue in public discourse, especially in a trilateral context, the workshop helped lower conceptual barriers and made complex ideas more accessible. This was evident when many students noted that they enjoyed being exposed to unfamiliar concepts during the panel discussion. This exposure broadened participants' understanding of maritime security and strategy as a relevant and dynamic policy domain that can impact our daily lives. Overall, the experience demonstrated the value of educational forums in raising awareness of maritime strategy among audiences and in sharing innovative ideas that can foster trilateral cooperation.

- **JoongEon An**

  Meeting with youth in the local area, I believe this Busan AC Workshop is a starting point for enhancing interests among citizens in general. Seeing their sincere attentions to understand the contents given, and active participation on roundtable with speakers and panelists, I was sure that the future of trilateral relations are positive. Also, this workshop showed the visions of youth leaders in general. Even with time constraints on roundtable, most participants were willing to spend more time to discuss the current global issues regarding trilateral missions. As one of the participants, I was motivated by their enthusiasm for learning, and saw what I should do as future leaders and co-workers of these youths. I'm hoping that this very experience will be a cherishing moment for their future career, and become a milestone for their life-long journey.

- **Daehan Lee**

  U.S.-ROK-Japan trilateral cooperation is in the early phase of conceptualization. There is still room for further open discussions between the three parties particularly on finding a

common ground first and identifying fields of cooperation, integrating different strengths and capabilities of respective states, and most importantly, alignment of future interests. In this sense, Busan AC Workshop was a proper, timely occasion to interact with young leaders from various majors and find out how and what they think of ongoing maritime issues and threats from adversaries. Having observed all participants' enthusiasm and interests in key topics covered during the workshop despite the time constraint, I saw a much brighter future of trilateral cooperation, and ascertained the sustainable momentum. I truly hope students, speakers, and panelists will look ahead and go beyond TogetherWeTri, by taking roles of facilitating closer exchanges and people-to-people ties in public diplomacy and policy.

- **Ji-Yun Park**

  Busan AC Workshop was a brilliant opportunity to interact with local Busan students who were passionate to voice their opinions on regional cooperation. Many were appreciative of opportunities to engage with fellow youth leaders and learn new concepts regarding trilateral cooperation. It was clear that the audience came from diverse backgrounds who were wanting to contribute meaningfully to the discourse of trilateral cooperation in their reflective fields such as architecture, commerce, and education. It was also notable that international students studying in Busan came to the event and shared their own vision and interest in the trilateral cooperation.

- **Joseph Sejin Kim**

  The Busan AC Workshop was a fantastic opportunity to engage with some of the brilliant young leaders here in Korea and with the students who desire to learn more regarding trilateral cooperation. The discussions, to my surprise, were heavily focused on maritime security and technology and the sharing of information thereof. The presentations, while great in content, I thought were a little difficult for the general audience of the event to understand and for following events should include some time to explain the general concepts of maritime security to increase the audiences' perceptibility. One factor that I

found out from the interactions of this event is the importance of public outreach regarding this topic. It aligns with the Consulate General Dewey Moore's concern regarding the biggest hurdle in promoting this cooperation is the general public's perception and understanding of the importance and significance of US-ROK-Japan Trilateral Cooperation. I truly believe that this Roundtable and future events are going to have an immense impact and influence in public outreach!

- **Eunhyuk Cha (Participant)**

  As a participant, the Busan AC Workshop provided a meaningful opportunity to deepen my understanding of maritime security and the direction of trilateral cooperation among the United States, the Republic of Korea, and Japan. The discussions highlighted the evolving security environment on the Korean Peninsula, including maritime tensions and nuclear threats, and emphasized the growing importance of maritime cooperation. The panels also delivered insights into Busan's strategic significance as a maritime hub within regional security frameworks. Open discussions addressed key challenges to trilateral cooperation, including historical issues between the ROK and Japan, and explored ways to overcome them through dialogue and trust-building. The opportunity to engage directly with panelists, including participants of the Young Trilateral Leaders Summit, made the workshop particularly insightful and impactful.

Ⅴ. Monitoring and Evaluation

A. Beneficiaries

1. **Direct Beneficiaries**

   The project directly engaged **42 participants**, including YTL alumni, invited speakers and panelists, and local university students based in Busan. Among them, **38 participants** registered through the official RSVP process and took part in core program activities such as keynote lectures, interactive roundtable discussions, and the policy proposal draft session.

Indirect Beneficiaries

Indirect beneficiaries include individuals reached through post-event dissemination and informal knowledge-sharing networks. The workshop generated approximately **120 online engagements** through official and participant-driven social media channels, extending the reach of the program beyond on-site participants.

B. Local Partners

The project was implemented through close collaboration with local institutional, academic, diplomatic, and media partners in Busan, strengthening subnational engagement and public outreach.

- **Busan American Corner**

  Provided venue support, program coordination, and on-site operational assistance, serving as the central hub for youth engagement and public diplomacy activities during the workshop.

- **Local Universities in Busan**

  To ensure broad outreach and academic diversity, the organizing team partnered with major universities in Busan, including **Pusan National University**, **Pukyong National University**, and **Korea Maritime and Ocean University**. Faculty and academic staff from relevant departments supported the project by promoting the workshop through departmental mailing lists, student networks, and university-affiliated media. These partnerships were strengthened through a combination of existing academic relationships and newly established connections formed for this program.

- **U.S. Consulate in Busan**

  Hosted a closed-door meeting with **Consul Dewey Moore** on Day 2, providing participants with diplomatic insights and reinforcing the connection between youth-led dialogue and official U.S. engagement at the regional level.

C. Media and Public Outreach Partners

Through strategic media and public outreach partnerships, TogetherWeTri expanded program visibility and strengthened pre- and post-event public engagement in Busan. Coverage through Pukyong National University Press and the Pukyong University English Newspaper supported campus-level dissemination in both Korean and English. In addition, Busan English Broadcasting (BeFM) featured the project on Morning Wave in Busan (December 18, 2025), contributing to advance awareness-building among local and international audiences. A subsequent live broadcast on BeFM Busan Worldwide (January 16, 2026) provided a post-event platform to amplify key program messages and youth perspectives. During the broadcast, TogetherWeTri highlighted the value of youth-led public diplomacy grounded in sustained people-to-people engagement, introduced the initiative as a U.S. Department of State–supported Alumni Engagement Innovation Fund (AEIF) project aligned with the Freedom 250 theme and underscored the role of accessible platforms, such as American Corners, in advancing inclusive dialogue and everyday civic engagement beyond formal summits. (*See Appendix A*)

Through these partnerships, the project enhanced coordination efficiency, broadened youth participation, and increased the visibility and sustainability of the U.S. Embassy–supported public diplomacy initiatives in Busan.

Ⅵ. Conclusion

Young Trilateral Leaders Regional Cooperation Roundtable in Busan workshop> reaffirmed the significance of trilateral cooperation grounded in regional contexts, highlighting Busan's role as a global maritime hub and the value of engaging local students in shaping future-oriented dialogue. Through open exchange and youth-led discussions, the program demonstrated how regional cooperation gains meaning when it is rooted in local realities and sustained by mutual understanding. Leveraging the American Corner network—operated jointly by the U.S. Embassy and local partner institutions in Korea—the #TogetherWeTri initiative continues to serve as a platform for shared values and open dialogue. Building on this foundation, the team looks forward to expanding engagement with a broader network of U.S. exchange alumni and further

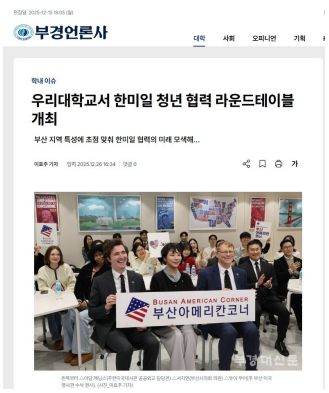
advancing awareness of the importance of U.S.–ROK–Japan cooperation through inclusive, region-based public diplomacy efforts.

Ⅶ. Appendix

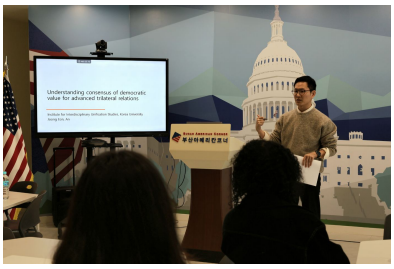
Appendix A. Media Coverage

- **Pukyong National University Press** (Korean-language coverage)
- **Pukyong University English Newspaper** (English-language coverage; link forthcoming)
- **Busan English Broadcasting (BeFM)**: Featured the project on *"Morning Wave in Busan"* (December 18, 2025), supporting pre-event public outreach and awareness-building among local and international audiences.

- **Busan English Broadcasting (BeFM)**: Featured TogetherWeTri on **"BeFM Busan Worldwide"** *(January 16, 2026)* through a live broadcast session, providing a post-event platform to amplify program messaging and youth perspectives.

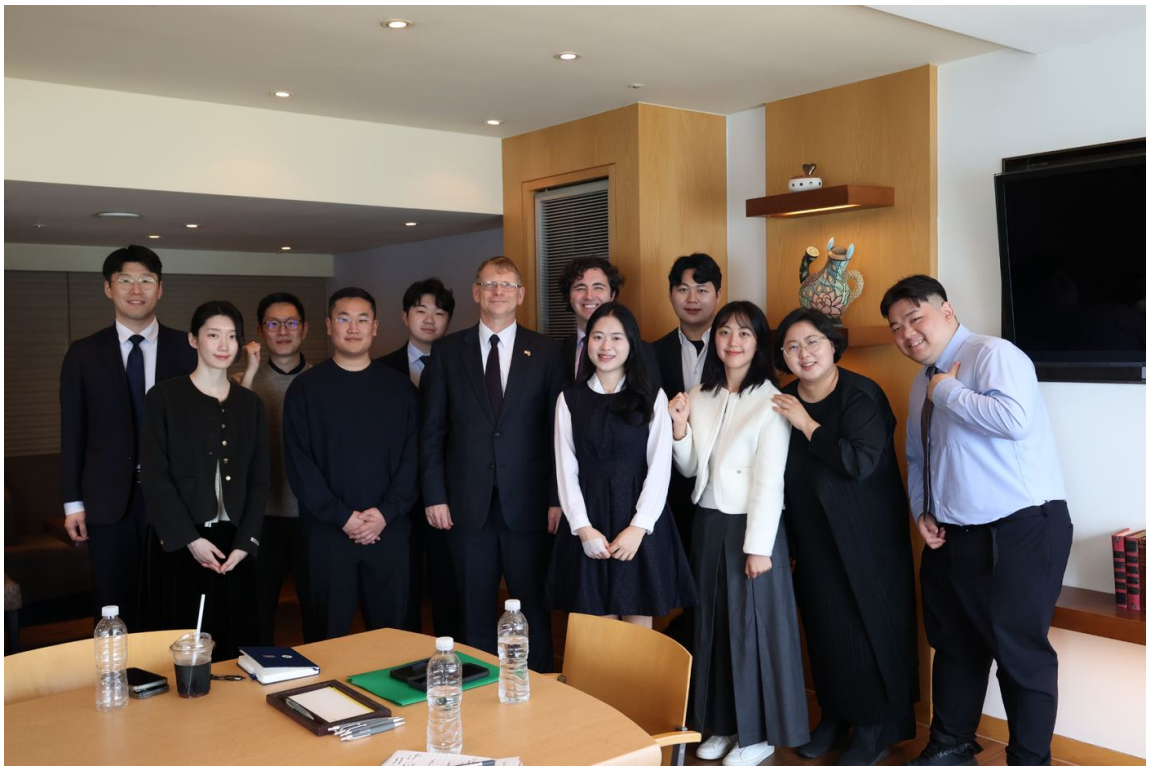
		
Pukyong National University Press	Busan English Broadcasting, Busan World Wide (BeFM) - Jan 16th	Busan English Broadcasting (BEFM), Morning Wave in Busan - Dec 18th

Appendix B. Photos and Videos

		
Opening	**Gabin Kim (Moderator)**	**Jiyeon Suh**
		
Jinwan Park	**Seunghwan Kim**	**JoongEon An**
		
Daehan Lee | Joseph Sejin Kim	**Ji-Yun Park | Seoyeong Lee | Seungbeom Ryan Son**	**Roundtable w/ local univ. students**


BUSAN AMERICAN CORNER
부산아메리칸코너
PUKYONG NATIONAL UNIVERSITY
국립부경대학교
AMERICA
250

Group Photo



Closed Meeting with Consul Dewey Moore		
		
Policy Proposal Meeting		

TogetherWeTri_Busan AC workshop Video_251219.mp4

Appendix C. Poster



**Submitted to U.S. Department of State in Washington D.C & U.S. Embassy Seoul Reporting*